

Unusual entrepreneurs ACCELERATORS



BABA KALYANI (RIGHT)
WITH HIS SON AMIT

AMIT
KALYANI, 33

BABA
KALYANI, 59

AUTO COMPONENT MANUFACTURER
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR AND CMD,
KALYANI GROUP
TURNOVER IN 1972 Rs 3.5 crore
CURRENT TURNOVER Rs 10,000 crore

STRAIGHT DRIVE

Baba Kalyani is a man in a hurry. So be it multiplying his company's turnover or completing an interview, the chairman and managing director of the Rs 10,000-crore Kalyani Group prefers to do it in record time. Not surprisingly, hours before the scheduled appointment at his headquarters in Pune, he seeks to advance the meeting by two hours. It's the same alacrity with which he narrates the journey of his flagship company Bharat Forge: "When I returned from the

Massachusetts Institute of Technology in 1972, my father was running a forging business with a turnover of Rs 3.5 crore. But I had no patience and wanted to grow the business via exports."

Today, Bharat Forge is India's largest auto components exporter. But it wasn't so simple 35 years ago. When 22 year-old Kalyani tried to tap the global markets, no country except the erstwhile Soviet Union was interested in components made by an Indian company. "We managed to crack the Russian market, thanks to our bilateral